🌱 COMMUNITY ACTION PROJECT · YEAR 9–10

Advanced Water Safety Community Action Project Guide

Plan, implement, and evaluate a real water safety awareness project for your school or local community. This guide takes you through five project phases, from needs analysis to evaluation.

Year 9–10 HPE | VC2HP10P08 | Community capacity building | Extended project | Assessment-ready

About this project: This guide aligns with VC2HP10P08 — "Plan, rehearse and evaluate strategies (including first aid and CPR) for managing situations where their own or others' health, safety or wellbeing may be negatively impacted at home, school and in the community." Completing this project gives you direct evidence of community health promotion skills that can also support VCE Health & Human Development pathways. Use your findings from the student workbook, WebQuest, and data analysis pack to inform your project.

🔎 Before you start — how to actually research this

The five phases below tell you *what* to produce. This tells you *how* to find out, which is the part people get stuck on. Work through these six steps in order. Each one has a stop-check: if you cannot answer it, go back rather than pushing on, because everything after it will be built on the gap.

1 Turn your topic into a question you could actually answer

“Drowning in Victoria” is a topic, not a question, and you cannot finish a topic. A question has a group, a place and something you want to know.

- Too broad: *Why do people drown?*
- Answerable: *Why are 15–24-year-olds over-represented in Victorian inland waterway drownings, and what has been tried?*

Stop-check: could someone disagree with your answer? If not, it is a fact-finding task, not an inquiry question, and there is nothing for you to argue.

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2 Decide what evidence would count *before* you go looking

Write down, now, what you would need to find to be convinced. Doing this first is what stops you collecting whatever turns up and calling it research.

- What numbers would show the problem is real?
- What would show a prevention approach worked — and what would show it did not?
- What would change your mind?

Stop-check: if every piece of evidence you listed would support what you already think, add one that would not.

3 Go to the primary sources first

Start with the organisations that collect the data, not with articles about them. Life Saving Victoria and Royal Life Saving Australia publish the reports that news stories are written from; the AIHW holds injury data. A news article is a secondary source, and the figure in its headline has usually lost the caveat that was in the report.

- Record the **organisation**, the **report title**, the **year** and the **page** as you go, not afterwards.
- If you cannot find where a figure came from, do not use it. That is the rule that keeps your brief defensible.

Stop-check: can you name the original source of every number you have written down? Not the website you read it on — the report it came from.

4 Put the evidence in a table before you write anything

One row per piece of evidence: the claim, the source, the year, and — the column people leave out — the limitation. Every figure has one. The multicultural drowning share has 22% of cases with country of birth unknown. A short reporting period cannot be compared with a full year.

Stop-check: is the limitation column filled in for every row? A blank there means you have not read the source properly, not that the figure is perfect.

5 Work out what the evidence says — including where it disagrees

Look across the table rather than down it. Where do sources agree? Where do they conflict, and is that because they measured different years, different places, or different things? A conflict you can explain is a strength in your brief; one you ignore is what a reader will find first.

Stop-check: state your finding in one sentence without using the word “shows”. If you cannot, you have a pile of evidence rather than a finding.

6 Make a recommendation the evidence can carry

Your recommendation has to follow from what you found, not from what you wanted to recommend when you started. If the evidence is thin, say so and recommend something proportionate — “trial and evaluate” is a legitimate recommendation and an honest one.

- What exactly should happen, and who does it?
- Which piece of evidence supports it?
- How would anyone know afterwards whether it worked?

Stop-check: could a reader trace your recommendation back to a specific row in your evidence table? If not, it is an opinion with research attached to it.

*This is the same **Read** → **Risk** → **Respond** → **Review** shape you use on scenario cards, stretched across a project: understand the situation, work out what matters, decide what to do, then check it. If you can see that, you have the method rather than six instructions.*

1 Needs Analysis — What Problem Are You Solving?

VC2HP10P02 · VC2HP10P08 | ~1 lesson

Before designing any project, you need to understand the specific need you are addressing. Use Victorian drowning data and your school context to identify the gap your project will fill.

1. What specific water safety gap or problem have you identified?

Think: who in your school community is at risk? What do they not know or not do? Use data from the LSV Drowning Report to justify your choice.

e.g. 'Year 9–10 students at our school swim at the unpatrolled dam near the school on hot days. They are in the 15–24 age group that accounts for 1 in 5 Victorian drowning deaths. They do not know the dangers of cold water shock at inland waterways.'

2. Who is your target audience?

Be specific — not just "students." Which year levels, which demographic, which context?

e.g. Year 9–10 students, aged 14–16, at [school name], who swim recreationally near wate

3. Evidence for the need — cite at least ONE statistic with a source URL.

Statistic: _____ Source URL: _____

Additional evidence (optional): _____

4. Why isn't this gap already being addressed? What structural or awareness barrier exists?

e.g. 'The school's current water safety education stops at Year 8 and doesn't address inland waterways. Students are not aware of cold water shock or the risks specific to the dam they visit.'

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2 Project Design — What Will You Do and Why?

VC2HP10P08 · VC2HP10P09 | ~1–2 lessons

5. Project name and one-sentence summary

Project name: _____

Summary (one sentence): _____

6. Choose your project type (tick one or more):

☐ Social media awareness campaign	☐ Poster / display in school
☐ Assembly or class presentation	☐ Parent / community flyer
☐ Peer education session	☐ School website / newsletter article
☐ Event or activity (e.g. safety quiz)	☐ Other: _____

7. Key messages — what do you want your audience to KNOW, THINK, and DO after engaging with your project?

Know (facts / information)	Think (change in attitude)	Do (specific behaviour change)

8. Priority matrix — plot your project options on the matrix below. Label each option by letter (A, B, C…). Choose the quadrant with HIGH impact and HIGH feasibility.

↑ High Impact	Low Feasibility	High Feasibility
	HIGH IMPACT / LOW FEASIBILITY Worth fighting for — but requires resources	HIGH IMPACT / HIGH FEASIBILITY ⭐ Your first priority
↓ Low Impact	LOW IMPACT / LOW FEASIBILITY Avoid — not worth the effort	LOW IMPACT / HIGH FEASIBILITY Easy wins — supplementary only

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3 Implementation Plan — Who Does What by When?

VC2HP10P08 · ~1 lesson

Task	Responsible person(s)	Due date	Resources needed	Done? ✓

Potential barriers and how you will overcome them:

Potential barrier	How you will overcome it

4 Evaluation Design — How Will You Know If It Worked?

VC2HP10P08 · Design before implementation

Design your evaluation *before* you implement — this is how real public health campaigns measure success. A good success metric is: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound (SMART).

Outcome to measure	How you will measure it	Success threshold (what "success" looks like)	When you will measure
Awareness of key water safety message	*e.g. Pre/post quiz, 5 questions*	*e.g. 70%+ correct after exposure*	*Immediately after*

Write your primary success metric as a SMART statement:

e.g. 'At least 80% of Year 9–10 students who view our Instagram campaign will correctly identify the three key signs of a rip current, as measured by a 3-question quiz posted 24 hours after the campaign launch.'

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5 Reflection & Evaluation — What Did You Learn?

VC2HP10P08 | Complete after implementation

Did you meet your success metric? What evidence do you have?

Refer to specific data from your evaluation (e.g. quiz results, engagement metrics, attendance numbers)…

What worked well? Why?

Be specific — what design decisions, messages, or delivery methods were most effective?

What would you do differently next time?

Identify at least two specific improvements with reasoning…

How does your project connect to the broader social determinants of drowning risk you studied in the unit?

e.g. 'Our project targeted gender norms by reframing risk assessment as intelligence rather than weakness. This addressed the structural factor of masculinity norms that contributes to the 85% male drowning rate in Victoria.'

Project completion checklist:

- [ ] Needs analysis completed with at least one cited statistic
- [ ] Target audience clearly defined
- [ ] Key messages (Know / Think / Do) stated
- [ ] SMART success metric designed before implementation
- [ ] Project implemented and documented (photos, screenshots, attendance, etc.)
- [ ] Evaluation data collected against the success metric
- [ ] Reflection completed connecting project to unit content

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Emilie Harrison · swimwater.safety@gmail.com

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